

# Midterm Exam Sample

## 1. Multiple Choice or Multiple Answers

For questions with square options ( $\square$ ), select all that apply.

- (a) Assume  $x$  and  $y$  get multiplied together element-wise:  $x * y$ . Let  $S_x$  and  $S_y$  be the shapes of  $x$  and  $y$  respectively. For which of the following will Numpy or Tensorflow throw a shape error?
- ☐  $S_x = [100, 10], S_y = [10, 100]$
  - ☐  $S_x = [1, 10], S_y = [10, 10]$
  - ☐  $S_x = [1, 10], S_y = [1, 10]$
  - ☐  $S_x = [1, 10, 100], S_y = [1, 1, 1]$
- (b) When the gradient flows backward through the sigmoid activation functions in backpropagation, it cannot change sign.
- ☐ True
  - ☐ False
- (c) Which of the following statements is true about skip-gram?
- ☐ It predicts the center word from the surrounding context words
  - ☐ The final word vector for a word is the average or sum of the center vector  $\mathbf{v}$  and context vector  $\mathbf{u}$  corresponding to that word
  - ☐ On small corpora, it has better performance than Glove
  - ☐ It makes use of global co-occurrence statistics

2. **Gradient Descent** Adagrad is a modification to the stochastic gradient descent algorithm used to update parameters. Updates are performed using the following formula:

$$c^{(t)} = \sqrt{(g^{(1)})^2 + \dots + (g^{(t-1)})^2 + \epsilon}$$
$$\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t - \frac{\eta}{c^{(t)}} g^{(t)}$$

where  $\theta$  is the parameter to be updated,  $g^{(t)}$  is the gradient of the loss with respect to  $\theta$ ,  $\epsilon$  is a smoothing parameter and  $\eta$  is the learning rate.  $c^{(0)}$  is initialized to zero at the start of the algorithm. State two differences between Adagrad and SGD in terms of step size (learning rate) and describe what effect they would have. **Note: This is more of a machine learning question.**

## 3. Advanced RNNs

- (a) Assume you choose to use LSTM instead of a vanilla RNN in a language modeling task. In one LSTM cell, how many gates are defined and what are they?
- (b) In your LSTM model, if the input vector:  $x_t = 0$ , then you get:  $h_t = h_{t-1}$ .
- ☐ True
  - ☐ False
- (c) The outputs of all the gates in the LSTM model are non-negative values.
- ☐ True
  - ☐ False